

SKILLS FOR PROFESSIONAL FREELANCERS

Participants Handout

Session 3

Personal Branding



01 Session Map

Learning Objectives:

- Define personal branding and explain why it matters for freelancers.
- Use the A-C-E-V pillars to assess the strength of a personal brand.
- Apply the five-dimension framework from goals to community.
- Create and evaluate an elevator pitch with AI support.
- Choose suitable platforms and improve a LinkedIn profile.
- Turn one idea into a one-week content plan while protecting authenticity and accuracy.

Your Workbook Journey

1. Clarify	2. Design	3. Express	4. Publish	5. Connect
Goals and value	Voice and visual identity	Elevator pitch	Platform and content	Community and networking

Use the workbook as evidence.

Write real examples, select only claims you can support, and return to earlier pages as your brand decisions become clearer.

Reflect & Write

Before this session, what did you think personal branding meant?

My current definition:

One question I want this session to answer:

02 Your Brand Is Already Speaking

Personal branding is the practice of crafting and communicating what makes you unique - your values, skills, and personality - so that the right people can recognize your value.



Promise	Proof	Perception
What you want to be known for.	Evidence that supports the promise.	What other people actually remember.

Brand Evidence Clients Notice

- **Professionalism:** how you show up and communicate.
- **Ease of working:** how simple and respectful the experience feels.
- **Reliability:** whether your delivery matches your promise.

Three words I want clients to repeat	
One piece of proof I already have	
One perception I need to strengthen	

Reflect & Write

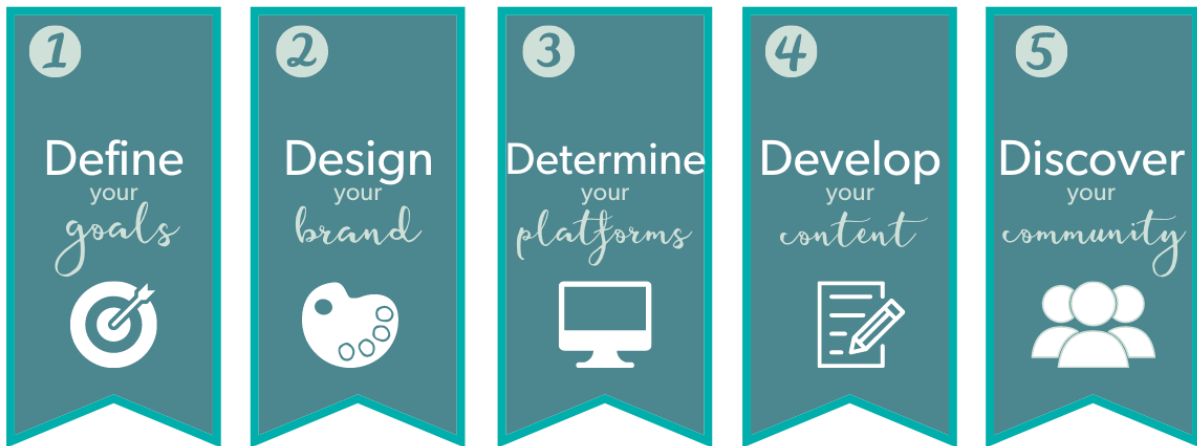
If a client described you after a successful project, what would you want them to say?

03 The A-C-E-V Brand Check



PB5D FrameworkTM

Leanne Calderwood's Personal Branding Five Dimension Framework



Pillar	Meaning	Evidence to Look For	Rating 1-5
Authenticity	True to your values and voice.	Choices, tone, and work that feel genuinely yours.	
Consistency	Promise, tone, and quality stay aligned.	The same value and experience across touchpoints.	
Expertise	Knowledge and skills are visible.	Insights, solutions, testimonials, and case evidence.	
Visibility	Present where your audience pays attention.	Profiles, content, conversations, and communities.	

A strong brand balances all four pillars.

Visibility without expertise creates attention without trust. Expertise without visibility stays hidden. Consistency makes your promise recognizable, while authenticity makes it believable.

My strongest pillar + evidence

My priority pillar + next action

Reflect & Write

Which pillar would create the greatest improvement in your freelance brand right now?

04 Define Your Brand Goal



A personal brand works best when it supports a clear goal. Choose one primary goal for the next stage of your career or freelance journey.

Possible Goals

- ☐ Nurture a professional relationship.
- ☐ Create a sale or win a client.
- ☐ Attract new opportunities.
- ☐ Seek a new job position or role.
- ☐ Contribute to the industry.

My Goal Card

Primary brand goal	
Audience I need to reach	
Action I want them to take	
Evidence that the goal is working	
Review date	

Reflect & Write

How should your brand help you move closer to this goal?

05 Design the Brand from the Inside Out



Brand Inputs

Personality I want people to feel	
Strengths I can demonstrate	
Traits I want to be known for	
Topics or problems I care about	
Values I will not compromise	

Visual Identity Draft

Element	My Choice	Why It Fits My Brand
Logo or symbol		
Color theme		
Language and tone		
Typography		

Design should reinforce the promise.

A recognizable look helps consistency, but your behaviour and delivery must still provide the proof.

06 AI Brand Lab: Elevator Pitch

Step	Action
1. Feed inputs	Provide your field, goal, strengths, personality, and passion.
2. Generate	Request three 30-second versions: formal, friendly, and bold.
3. Critique	Evaluate each version against Authenticity, Consistency, Expertise, and Visibility.
4. Humanize	Edit the strongest version in your own voice and read it aloud.

Ready-to-Use Prompt

Act as a personal branding coach. I am a freelancer in [your field]. My goal is [goal]. My strengths are [strengths], and my personality is [traits]. Write 3 versions of a 30-second elevator pitch: formal, friendly, and bold. Do not invent experience or results.

Compare the Three Versions

Version	Sounds Like Me?	Shows Value?	Memorable?	Best Line
Formal				
Friendly				
Bold				

My final 30-second pitch	
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Reflect & Write

What did you change so the pitch became more authentic and accurate?

07 Choose the Right Platform



Platform	Best Use	Control	My Fit
Personal website	Your home on the internet and full portfolio.	High	
LinkedIn	Networking, credibility, and value-led content.	Medium	
Freelancing platforms	Visibility where clients are already searching.	Lower	

Platform Decision Canvas

Primary audience	
Where they already pay attention	
Proof I can show there	
Content format I can sustain	
Primary platform for the next 30 days	

Choose for fit, not fashion.

The best platform is the one that reaches your audience, supports the proof you can show, and matches the effort you can sustain.

Reflect & Write

Why is your selected platform the strongest match for your current goal?

08 LinkedIn Profile Makeover

Profile Checklist

- ☐ Use a professional headshot.
- ☐ Add certifications or awards that support your positioning.
- ☐ Create a unique, relevant headline.
- ☐ Ask credible peers or professors to endorse your skills.
- ☐ Update your profile regularly.
- ☐ Share relevant academic and professional achievements.
- ☐ Follow groups, professionals, and companies in your field.
- ☐ Use your refined elevator pitch as the basis of your About section.
- ☐ Comment and react thoughtfully to your connections' posts.

My LinkedIn Audit

Profile Area	Current Strength	Improvement	Deadline
Photo + banner			
Headline			
About section			
Experience + proof			
Activity + network			

Reflect & Write

Write a headline that identifies your field, value, and audience.

Draft headline:

09 Develop Content That Sounds Like You



Short Posts	Long Articles	Audio	Video	Images
Quick insight	Deeper expertise	Voice and ideas	Demonstration	Visual proof

My Content Foundation

Audience I want to help	
Three topics I can speak about	
Experience or proof I can use	
Tone: professional / friendly / bold	
One idea worth sharing this week	

Use consistent brand vocabulary.

Repeat a small number of clear ideas, terms, and proof points. Consistency helps people understand and remember what you stand for.

Reflect & Write

What should your audience learn, feel, or do after engaging with your content?

10 AI Brand Lab: One Idea, One Week

Step	Action
1. Pick	Choose one useful insight from your field.
2. Repurpose	Create a LinkedIn post, article outline, and 60-second video or carousel script.
3. Check	Verify facts, remove confidential details, and edit the tone so it sounds like you.
4. Schedule	Place the three pieces into a simple one-week plan.

Ready-to-Use Prompt

Here is an insight from my work: [your idea]. Turn it into: 1) a short LinkedIn post with a hook, 2) an outline for a long-form article, and 3) a 60-second video script. Keep my tone: [professional / friendly / bold]. Preserve the meaning and do not invent facts.

One-Week Content Plan

Day	Format	Main Message	Evidence	Status
Day 1	LinkedIn post			
Day 3	Article outline			
Day 5	Video / carousel			

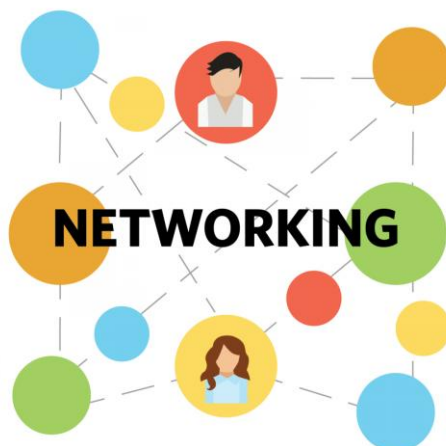
Human Quality Check

- ☐ Every claim is accurate.
- ☐ No confidential or personal data is included.
- ☐ The tone sounds like my real voice.
- ☐ The three pieces support the same brand promise.

Reflect & Write

Which AI output needed the most editing, and what did you change?

11 Discover and Grow Your Community



- **Social media:** join useful conversations and share value.
- **Email:** send relevant, respectful messages.
- **Direct messages:** start focused one-to-one conversations.
- **Mentions:** recognize people and ideas thoughtfully.
- **Networking:** build relationships virtually and in person.

Networking is personal.

Find a style that feels comfortable and sustainable. Some people thrive in large events; others build better relationships through one-to-one conversations or LinkedIn.

Effective Networking Rules

- ☐ Use positive language with empathy.
- ☐ Listen closely and avoid interrupting.
- ☐ Use consistent brand vocabulary.
- ☐ Give thorough answers to technical questions.
- ☐ Keep communication clear and concise.

My Next Connection

Person or community	
Reason to connect	
Value I can offer first	
Opening message	
Follow-up date	

12 My Personal Brand Starter Kit



Your brand is built through repeated evidence.

A clear promise attracts attention. Consistent proof earns trust. Useful visibility keeps the right people aware of your value.

Starter Kit Summary

Brand goal	
Three words I want remembered	
Strongest A-C-E-V pillar	
Priority pillar to improve	
Final elevator pitch	
Primary platform	
One content idea	
First networking action	
Action within 48 hours	
Review date	

Personal Brand Commitment

Complete this sentence: I want to be known for...
